

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Evaluate Programmes, Not Just Scores

What leaders should authorize, require, and refuse

Production Unit	PU-B07-C49
Decision status	Controlled learning asset
Audience	Executives, programme owners, statisticians, technical leads
Data	Synthetic examples only

Executive takeaway: Evaluate education programmes using explicit theory, counterfactual logic, implementation evidence, outcomes, equity, costs, uncertainty, and decision relevance.

Why it matters

Before-and-after scores can misattribute change and encourage scaling a programme that was ineffective, unequal, or poorly implemented.

Illustrative application

An evaluation separates score change from plausible programme contribution and checks who benefited, at what cost, and under which conditions.

Minimum approval conditions

- Named accountable owner and lawful purpose
- Defined evidence, provenance, reference period, population, and geography
- Decision-relevant validation and visible uncertainty
- Documented abstention, referral, override, and incident processes
- Accessibility, equity, security, retention, and retirement review

Non-negotiable boundary

The analytical system may inform review. It may not independently authorize benefits, sanctions, enforcement, clinical treatment, school exclusion, displacement, or another consequential action.